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Senate of Virginia Floor Session, Friday, February 6, 2026

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[00:24:43] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, Senate chamber.

[00:27:48] The Senate will come to order.

[00:28:09] The Senators will please take their seats. Those persons not entitled to the privileges of the floor will retire to the gallery. The Senators and all in attendance will please stand, if you are able, and be led in prayer by Bishop Michelle Thomas from Holy and Whole Life Changing Ministries International located in Leesburg.

[00:28:33] And following the prayer, everyone will please remain standing and be led in the Pledge of Allegiance to the flag of the United States of America by Senate page Madison Nestor of Loudon. Good morning. Good morning.

[00:28:49] Honorable senators, distinguished leaders, and fellow Virginians, let us pray. Eternal God, our Father, we come before you this morning, standing on sacred ground, ground that's been watered not only by prayer and protest and perseverance, and progress, but by the blood, sweat, and tears of our ancestors, our people. This Capitol is a living testimony of our resilience and your power to help your people overcome every situation.

[00:29:22] As we celebrate the 100th year of Black History Month, we acknowledge that black history is not just a footnote in Virginia. It is foundational to the American story. God, we lift before you our leaders. We thank you for your change. We thank you right now for our governor. We thank you for our lieutenant governor. We thank you for our attorney general. We thank you for their administration and our 164th Virginia General Assembly. Grant them the wisdom to rise above politics, courage that

[00:29:59] stands firm even in the face of every storm. Give them the compassion that that reaches every community in the Commonwealth. God, you see all and you know all. You see the struggles around education. You see the struggles around health care, housing and voted access.

[00:30:18] You see the struggles around our unemployed brothers and sisters. You see the struggles around immigration. You see the war on human dignity. You know that the families are weary. You know that the voices are crying for justice and not just rhetoric.

[00:30:36] So cover your senators, unify them without erasing them, strengthening them without hardening them. Protect them, protect their minds, their bodies, and their spirits. Now, unto him who's able to do exceedingly, abundantly, above all we can ask or think, according to the power that's working in us.

[00:31:00] God, we ask that you power each and every senator up. In Jesus' name, amen. I pledge allegiance to the flag of the United States of America, and to the republic for which it stands, one nation, under God, indivisible, with liberty and justice for our own.

[00:31:31] The clerk will call the roll. All those present, please vote aye. The clerk will close the roll.

[00:32:10] You have a quorum, Madam President. Senate Journal for Thursday, February 5, 2026. The senator from Arlington moves that the reading of the journal be waived. All in favor of waiving the reading

of the journal will record their vote aye.

[00:32:28] Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 35, noes 5. Ayes 35, noes 5.

[00:32:44] The reading of the journal is waived. The clerk will report any communication from the House of Delegates. The chair recognizes the senior senator from Prince William.

[00:33:03] Madam President, I move to waive the reading, I'm sorry, the house communications. The question is, shall the reading of the communication be waived? All in favor of waiving the reading of the communication from the house of delegates will record their votes aye, those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote?

[00:33:21] Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote?

[00:33:40] The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 34, noes 6. Ayes 34, noes 6. The reading of the communication is waived. The clerk will report any communications from the governor. I do not have any, Madam President. We've now arrived in the time of the morning hour when we have the honor of welcoming our distinguished guests who are joining us in the Senate gallery.

[00:34:06] I give my daily reminder about our procedure. A senator will rise and provide an introduction for their visitors. I will then offer the welcome of the Senate, and I ask that we all hold our applause until I've completed the welcome from the Senate.

[00:34:25] The chair recognizes the junior senator from Loudoun. - Good morning, Madam President. - Good morning. - Thank you. I rise for the purpose of an introduction. - The senator has the floor. - Thank you, Madam President. Today's prayer was offered by Bishop Michelle Thomas from the Holy and Whole Life-Changing Ministries Leesburg, Virginia. For more than 20 years, Bishop Thomas has provided tireless spiritual leadership and guidance to families and communities across Loudoun County and beyond. She's the founder of

[00:34:59] her ministry, which in 2006 became the first church in Loudoun County to be founded by an African-American woman and made history again last fall with her consecration as bishop under the Joint College of African-American Pentecostal Bishops.

[00:35:17] Beyond the pulpit, Bishop Thomas has demonstrated deep commitment to service, justice, and equity through her work with the Loudoun NAACP and the Loudoun Freedom Center, helping preserve history while advancing equity and opportunity for all.

[00:35:34] She has also been appointed to the Commission on African-American History, Education, and the Loudoun Heritage Commission. Today we are grateful for her leadership and the inspiration she brings to our Commonwealth. I hope you will all join me in extending her the warm welcome of the Senate.

[00:35:53] - Thank you, Senator, for that introduction. And Bishop, thank you again for joining us. Thank you for being a role model in so many ways as a history and change maker. Thank you for your dedication to education to the preservation of history which is so important to each of us here in the Commonwealth. Senators I ask that we give the warm welcome of the Senate to Bishop Michelle Thomas. The chair recognizes the senator from Eastern

[00:36:30] Henrico. Good morning Madam President I rise for an introduction. The senator has the floor. Madam President it is my pleasure to introduce the students from the representatives from the American Scandinavian Student Exchange International Program and I'd ask that they please stand. Madam President this organization has a long history of promoting international understanding through educational exchange. In 2025 we welcomed high school exchange students to the United States from nearly 50 countries representing every populated excuse me continent. Their visit to the General Assembly is part of their

[00:37:07] educational mission giving them a first-hand look at representative democracy that is our Commonwealth. Visiting us today are three exchange students from Latvia, the Netherlands, and Tajikistan. Yes, I ask that you would please join me and give the students as well as their representatives a warm welcome of the Senate. Thank you Senator for that introduction and welcome to our international exchange students. We're so delighted that you are visiting the capital city of Virginia delighted that you've had the opportunity to visit the

[00:37:46] capital and I hope you've been able to visit some of our legislators and speak to them about your experiences as international students and I know you're going to be carrying your message and the knowledge you've gained back to Latvia to the Netherlands and to Tajikistan I will get it right someday so but thank you so much for joining us and for for being present in the gallery senators I ask that we give the warm welcome of the Senate to the

[00:38:18] International Exchange high school students who have joined us today the chair recognizes the senator from Stafford thank you madam president of Rice for an introduction the senator has the floor madam president today in the gallery we are joined by Miss Virginia Madison Whitbeck and Miss Virginia's teen Ariana guest if they were there they are. Madam President Madison Whitback currently serves as Miss Virginia and she's representing the Commonwealth through service scholarship and leadership. She's a student at Belmont

[00:38:57] although I had a chance to chat with them beforehand and she is of course on her one-year sabbatical to serve the Commonwealth in her role and she's working toward a degree a bachelor in music degree. She is a phenomenal singer. Madison is a lifetime performer and advocate for arts education and she leads her initiative Arts for All which promotes confidence self-expression access to music and theater for students of all abilities and you couldn't think of a better champion for that she certainly espouses all of those during her 10 year of service Madison travels across Virginia engaging with schools community organizations and state partners to promote healthy habits

[00:39:36] creativity and civic leadership as a representative of miss america's organization she is committed to empowering young people and strengthening communities across the commonwealth and then we have ariana guest who currently serves as miss virginia's teen she is a sophomore she's one of the younger ones i found out she's only 15 years old at tab high school and a national award-winning dancer who aspires to one day attend acclaimed juilliard school of dance i have no doubt you will A lifelong performer, Ariana is deeply committed to mentorship, serving as a role model and leader for younger dancers at her studio, and you're certainly on your way, and throughout her community.

[00:40:13] After her youngest sister was born prematurely at just 23 weeks, Ariana became passionate about advocating for NICU families and raising awareness around the importance of emotional community support during extended hospital stays. Throughout her year of service, Ariana travels across

Virginia, engaging in students, families and organization to promote resilience please join me in recognizing these two dynamic young women and welcome them to the Capitol today thank you senator for that introduction and welcome to Miss teen Virginia Ariana guest and Miss Virginia Madison Whitbeck thank you so much for your advocacy on these critical

[00:40:52] issues that you are speaking about and sharing your own knowledge and passion so that you can advocate for so many others thank you for the work you're doing. Thank you for the representation you're providing. Senators, I ask that we give the warm welcome of the Senate to Miss Teen Virginia and Miss Virginia. Is

[00:41:20] there any other business for the morning hour? The Senate will be at ease. The

[00:46:30] clerk will call the calendar. Senate calendar for Friday, February 6, 2026. Uncontested calendar, Senate bills on third reading. The chair recognizes the senator from Eastern Fairfax. Madam President, I move that all the Senate bills on third reading, uncontested calendar on pages 1 through 7, Senate Bills 10 through 771 to be placed on their final passage in a block. Any senator desiring to remove a bill from the block should do so after the clerk has read the number of the bill. The question is, shall the Senate

[00:47:05] bills on the uncontested calendar, third reading, pages 1 through 7, Senate Bill 10 through Senate Bill 771, be placed on their final passage in the block with the understanding that any senator desiring to remove a bill from the block will do so after the clerk has read the number of the bill.

[00:47:23] All in favor of that motion, we'll say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The motion is agreed to. The bills are before us in the block. The clerk will read the number of the bills. Senate Bill 10, Senate Bill 35, Senate Bill 41, Senate Bill 56, Senate Bill 100, Senate Bill 170, Senate Bill 204, Senate Bill 240, Senate Bill 286, Senate Bill 316, Senate Bill

[00:48:00] 319, Senate Bill 362, Senate Bill 517, Senate Bill 669, Senate Bill 771. The question is, shall the bills in the block now pass? Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 40 no zero. Ayes 40 no zero. The bills in the block pass. Regular

[00:48:39] calendar. Senate bills on third reading. Senate bill 583. A bill relating to parking stopping and standing enforcement. Bus obstruction monitoring systems civil penalties. The chair recognizes the senator from central Fairfax. Madam President I move that the bill pass and speaking to that motion.

[00:48:59] Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Senate Bill 583 is related to essentially improving access, safety, and reliability for bus transit riders in Virginia. This is simply adding a monitor to it to ensure that anything that obstructs in that, in the bus lane, there's a penalty to that.

[00:49:23] We made an amendment yesterday to ensure that that is clarified so it is only anything that is on the bus lane itself and not necessarily any extra things around that so with that I hope we can pass this bill. The chair recognizes the senator from Eastern Henrico. The chair recognizes the senator from Botetat. Thank you Madam President. Will the senator yield for a question?

[00:49:50] Will the senator yield? I yield. The senator has the floor. Thank you Madam President. I would ask Since this is going to be video cameras on the bus and it's going to be used in potential for enforcement and a penalty on that, what happens to the footage on that?

[00:50:09] How long is this kept? Is there any kind of provision on that or any way that we know that this something else, the existing sections are going to apply or is this just stay around forever? Is there any response for that? Senator from Central Fairfax. thank you madam chair and to answer the gentleman uh at the way this bill is written and the way the technology is set up uh it does not keep any of the video footage or the recording unless it is for the purposes of issuing out an inf an infraction so if it does capture footage within three seconds of that it is deleted unless somebody is going to go and get an infraction

[00:50:44] i thank you gentlemen the question is shall senate bill 583 pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll.

[00:51:16] Ayes 21, noes 18. Ayes 21, noes 18. Senate Bill 583 passes. Senate Bill 595, a bill relating to mechanics and storage liens, abandoned vehicles, vehicle records. The chair recognizes the senior Senator from Virginia Beach thank you madam president as we explained yesterday this is when we put the substitute on this basically streamlines the out of sight out of state title searches for DMV with that madam president I move the passage of this bill thank you the question is shall

[00:51:55] Senate bill 595 pass all in favor of that motion will record record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the

[00:52:05] senators voted. Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 29, noes 11. Ayes 29, noes 11. Senate Bill 595 passes. Senate Bill 28, a bill relating to overtime for certain employees, domestic workers. The chair recognizes the senator from Eastern Prince William. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move the bill pass and speaking to the bill. Senator has the floor thank you madam president uh madam president currently live-in domestic workers are

[00:52:45] not entitled to virginia's protections to receive overtime wages these protections were extended to domestic workers in 2021 under the virginia overtime wage act but were excluded in 2022 when virginia realigned overtime standards to the fair labor standards act this bill would reinstate overtime protections for live-in domestic workers giving them the same rights of overtime offered to all domestic and low-wage workers.

[00:53:09] I hope it is the will of the body to pass this bill. The question is, shall Senate Bill 28 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no, are the senators ready to vote?

[00:53:24] Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 22, noes 18. Ayes 22, noes 18. Senate Bill 28 passes.

[00:53:39] Senate Bill 42, a bill relating to school boards, powers and duties, school meal policies, payment of school meal debt. The chair recognizes the senator from Western, Prince William. Thank you, Madam President, Madam President, I move patches of bill and speaking to the motion.

[00:53:56] Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, this is now a happy little section one bill as a substituted, and so now it says that the Department of Education shall evaluate the impact on requiring each school board at the end of a school year to pay for the total unpaid school meal debt balance on the nonprofit food service account of each public elementary or secondary school in the school division resulting from uncollectible school meal debts on any student account. There's five little clauses that come along with that and the whole point of that is to look at what we do in Prince

William County where at the end of a school year rather than assigning that school meal debt directly to the schools the school division takes

[00:54:34] responsibility for that so section 1 bill and with that our new passage of the bill the question is shall Senate bill 42 pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll I was 40 no zero eyes 40 no zero Senate bill 42 passes Senate Bill 50, a bill relating to lobbying, registration, local government's penalty.

[00:55:16] The chair recognizes the junior senator from Virginia Beach. Thank you, Madam President. I move the bill to pass. I'm speaking to that motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. This bill just expends the definition of lobbying to include the local government. And this bill just aims to provide transparency, ensure that our lobbying laws are applied consistently across all levels of government.

[00:55:37] The question is, shall Senate Bill 50 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted?

[00:55:53] Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 21, noes 19. Ayes 21, noes 19. Senate Bill 50 passes. Senate Bill 82, a bill relating to clerk fees, secure remote access to non-confidential court records by certain attorneys.

[00:56:14] The chair recognizes the senator from Central Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I move that the bill pass. And speaking to that. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. The objective of this bill is to give a little bit of financial relief to court-appointed attorneys who defend people of limited means. Because the pay is very modest, localities struggle to keep enough qualified attorneys on their court-appointed list.

[00:56:39] Each jurisdiction has their own fee for electronic access to court records, disincentivizing attorneys from serving in multiple localities. Under this bill, court-appointed attorneys would have this fee waived, which will encourage more attorneys to stay on that list and encourage attorneys on that list to serve in multiple localities. We made some clarification recently on this bill, so that the intention of this bill is to ensure that it gives the specific access only to attorneys who are currently and actively accepting court-appointed cases,

[00:57:15] so that it is not open to everyone who's approved. So Madam President, with that, I ask that we pass this bill. The question is, shall Senate Bill 82 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye.

[00:57:32] Those opposed no. Senators ready to vote. Have all the Senators voted. Do any Senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 28, noes 12. Ayes 28, noes 12. Senate Bill 82 passes.

[00:57:59] Senate Bill 161. A bill relating to health insurance limit on cost-sharing payments for prescription drugs under certain plans. The chair recognizes the senior senator from Loudoun. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move passage of the bill and speaking to that.

[00:58:14] Senator has the floor. - Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, this is a healthcare transparency and affordability bill. This bill offers consumers the option to choose a plan with a flat dollar

copay. This helps people, especially those struggling with complex and chronic diseases like diabetes and cancer, manage their out-of-pocket costs for their critically important prescriptions, Madam President.

[00:58:37] It means that they are able to budget for the entire year because their prescriptions come in at a flat dollar rate as about amount as opposed to not knowing how much or when they are going to have to pay for certain prescriptions, Madam President. And very importantly to this bill, the Bureau of Insurance determined that any difference in premiums would only apply to this class of people who chose this plan, not to the other plans on the insurance, Madam President.

[00:59:03] With that, I move passage. The question is, shall Senate Bill 161 now pass? All in favor of the motion will record their votes aye. those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll eyes 34 no 6 ice 34 no 6 Senate bill 161 passes Senate bill 212 a bill relating to TPA certified optometrist sale and dispensation of schedule 6 control

[00:59:41] substances requirements the chair recognizes the senator from northern Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I move the bill pass and speaking to the bill. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. This legislation would allow patients to receive medications directly from their optometrist at the time of diagnosis, delaying the start of treatment. 88% of the Commonwealth is rural, and this is a particularly rural health issue, as access to pharmaceuticals may be delayed due to lack of transportation. So optometrists are trained, they're certified, they're licensed to prescribe these Schedule VI medications.

[01:00:20] These are not narcotics. And this would allow them to dispense what they're already authorized to prescribe. And I move, I renew my motion that we pass the bill. The question is, shall Senate Bill 212 pass?

[01:00:38] All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any Senators desire to change their vote? The Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 40, noes 0.

[01:00:54] Ayes 40, noes 0. Senate Bill 212 passes. Senate Bill 215, a bill relating to prohibiting employer seeking wage or salary history of prospective employees, wage or salary range transparency, cause of action.

[01:01:18] The Chair recognizes the Senator from Northern Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. move we passed the bill and speaking to the bill senator has the floor thank you madam president uh you know in 1974 we pat the virginia passed the equal pay act however there were no no prescribed actions around what employers should or shouldn't do you may those of you who have been here for a long time may know that this is the 10th year that i have been working on this and we have passed it and it has been vetoed twice by the current governor um this bill would sim i mean the former

[01:01:52] governor let me excuse myself the former governor and this bill would simply say that when a prospective employer employee is coming in for an interview that they don't have to tell their past salary history when they are being interviewed unless they want to they also requires that the company would post a salary range for the prospective employees i did listen to the chamber of commerce however they asked for a curing process so that they would have 15 days to correct an action if they are not putting the the salary history i mean the salary range up

[01:02:33] and they removed their opposition to the bill i again this is is shown to really help lower the wage disparity among among people who are seeking seeking work and i ask that we pass the bill the question is shall Senate bill 215 pass all in favor of the motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the

[01:03:08] clerk will close the roll it's 21 nose 19 eyes 21 nose 19 Senate bill 215 passes Senate bill 271 a bill relating to prescription drug affordability board established drug cost affordability review the chair recognizes the senator from Charlottesville madam president I move the bill passed I'd like to speak to that motion senator has the floor madam chair for the last this is the fourth year so for three years this bill has been introduced in various forms I've

[01:03:44] introduced it a couple times it's been passed both in 2025 and 2024 past both chambers but was not signed into law. It's changed this year. It creates a prescription drug affordability board but that's not all it does. The prescription drug affordability board is an independent board that will there will be upper payment limits set for drugs. The whole idea is to keep the cost of prescription medications as low as possible. The drugs prescription drug affordability board is made up of people who are appointed by the governor and pointed by the General Assembly that will be independent, totally independent and have

[01:04:23] no conflict with respect to the pharmaceutical industry or with respect to anything else, hopefully. What this bill does that's different and because one criticism of this has been this approach has not produced immediate results in other states, though there are some prescription drug affordability boards that have produced some signs of success, what this drug, what What this bill does that's different is that the Board would have the ability to extend the lower prices negotiated for Medicare for 25 burdensome drugs to hundreds of thousands

[01:04:58] of Virginians in 2027 and 2028, after which the General Assembly would need to vote again to expand the Board's authority to review costs for additional drugs. So this legislation ensures savings from the first day it's effective.

[01:05:14] And I hope the bill will be passed. The question is, shall Senate Bill 271 pass? All in favor of the motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no, are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted?

[01:05:31] Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 31, noes 8. Ayes 31, noes 8. Senate Bill 271 passes.

[01:05:49] Senate Bill 324, a bill relating to Virginia Public Procurement Act, additional public works contract requirements.

[01:06:04] - The chair recognizes the senior senator from Fairfax. I'm sorry, my apologies. The senior senator from Prince William. - Thank you, Madam President. - You're a senior senator from somewhere.

[01:06:21] - I moved this set of bill, 324 passed, and speaking to the motion. - Senator has the floor. - Thank you, Madam President. I heard Saslaw say something already today, so. So the bill before you is a bill that helps strength in our public procurement and capital outlay process to ensure that those who are bidding and working on our contracts have not had recent violations of Fair Labor Standards Act that includes provisions about subcontracting as well to ensure that we don't have wage theft occurring on our own public contracts. I think this is very important where we don't have and

[01:06:57] are encouraging through our payment of our capital outlay projects for those who decide to not pay, for instance, taxes on the wages through subcontracting and other forces. So this is an important provision in our contracting efforts to ensure our tax dollars are spent wisely and with those who are acting responsibly and as the bill passed.

[01:07:21] The question is, shall Senate Bill 324 pass all in favor of the motion? Will record their votes aye, those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any Senators desire to change their vote?

[01:07:37] The Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 21, noes 19. Ayes 21, noes 19. Senate Bill 324 passes. Senate Bill 430, a bill relating to authority of local governments, service employees.

[01:07:52] The Chair recognizes the Senior Senator from Henrico. Thank you, Madam. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move the bill pass and speaking to that. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. President, this permits any locality in the Commonwealth to provide for certain requirements concerning successor service employees defined in the bill by local ordinance or resolution.

[01:08:14] For example, such local ordinance or resolution may require that the successor service employee retain incumbent service employees during a transition period of 90 days. Under the bill, service employees are those who perform work in connection with the care maintenance of a property and I renew my motion for the bill to pass. The question is shall Senate bill 430 pass all in favor of the motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the

[01:08:49] senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll. Ayes 21, noes 19. Ayes 21, noes 19. Senate Bill 430 passes. Senate Bill 433, a bill relating to employment insurance benefit eligibility conditions lockout exception to labor disputes qualification. The chair recognizes the senior senator from Henrico. Madam President, I move the

[01:09:27] bill passed and speaking to that senator has the floor madam president sb 433 requires that if a employer locks employees out then they will the employees will continue to receive their benefits and i renew my motion that the bill pass the question is shall senate bill 433 pass all in favor of the motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote Have all the senators voted?

[01:09:58] Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 21, noes 19. Ayes 21, noes 19. Senate Bill 433 passes.

[01:10:15] Senate Bill 586. A bill relating to use of artificial intelligence, right to expedited appeal, civil penalties. The chair recognizes the senator from Central Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I move that the bill pass and speaking to that motion.

[01:10:31] Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Senate Bill 583 is a bill related to AI usage in the health insurance industry. Insurance insurers are using AI without human review to reject some claim, including those that are identified as experimental or investigative.

[01:10:51] The fact that experimental and investigative procedures should be rejected doesn't solve the problem of AI falsely identifying the claims to be rejected. In this bill, we define AI in a way that is consistent with the definition that the SEC uses in its administrative procedures and other regulatory actions. The bill simply does the following. It requires that all carriers publicly disclose to the Bureau of

Insurance any use of AI to manage claims, submit information to the SEC upon their request, maintain documentation of AI

[01:11:29] decision for at least three years and provide notice to enrollees and health care providers when AI has been used to issue an adverse determination and provide a clear and timely process for appealing that determination. This ensures that the SEC has the information and the authority they need to monitor this industry and police bad actors. We are not saying we should not be using AI we're simply saying we need a seat at the table when it comes to the usage madam president with that I move that the bill pass the question is shall

[01:12:07] Senate bill 586 pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll as 22 noes 18. Ayes 22, noes 18. Senate Bill 5, 86 passes. Senate Bill 722, a bill relating to motion picture

[01:12:42] theaters, open captioning. The chair recognizes the senator from Norfolk. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I rise for a motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. I move that SB 722 pass and speaking to that motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President.

[01:13:02] uh senate bill 722 is a simple accessibility bill rooted in fairness deaf and hard of hearing virginians should be able to enjoy a movie with their family and friends together at the same time without barriers or special equipment too often deaf patrons must rely on closed caption devices that are uncomfortable unreliable or unavailable separating them from the shared movie going experience with family and friends senate bill 722 addresses this by ensuring open

[01:13:38] caption screenings where dialogue and sound cues appear directly on the screen this bill is carefully limited it does not require theaters to purchase new technology open captioning already exists in many digital cinema systems and this legislation simply ensures meaningful access when and that capability is available.

[01:14:02] The substitute sets clear reasonable requirements based on theater size, excludes drive-in movie theaters, and allows flexibility while ensuring transparency and accountability. At its core, Madam President, Senate Bill 722 is about inclusion and belonging for the deaf and hard of hearing in our society.

[01:14:26] Madam President, I renew my motion that the bill pass. The Chair recognizes the Senator from Western Fairfax. Does the Senator wish to speak? The question is, shall Senate Bill 722 pass?

[01:14:44] All in favor of the motion will record their votes aye, those opposed no. Are the Senators ready to vote? Have all the Senators voted? Do any Senators desire to change their vote? The Clerk will close the roll.

[01:15:00] Ayes 27, noes 13. Ayes 27, noes 13. Senate Bill 722 passes. bill 763 a bill relating to retail sales and use tax firearm and ammunition tax the chair recognizes the senator from norfolk thank you madam president madam president i rise for a motion senator has the floor thank you madam president madam president i move passage of the bill and speaking to that motion senator has the floor thank you senate bill 763 as amended by the the Senate Finance and Appropriations Committee

[01:15:40] is a measured fiscal policy that aligns public safety priorities with responsible revenue planning. As substituted, the bill establishes an 11% excise tax on firearms and ammunition

manufacturers applied to gross receipts from the sale and distribution of firearms and ammunition in the Commonwealth.

[01:16:02] This is assessed at the manufacturer level, not on individual consumers and the tax explicit the bill explicitly exempts sales to federal state and local law enforcement agencies ensuring that public safety operations are not impacted by this policy the sub the substitute also reflects two important refinements first it adjusts the effective date to july 1 2027 providing adequate time for implementation compliance and budget planning. This ensures predictability for the Department of Taxation and for

[01:16:39] affected manufacturers while allowing the Commonwealth to responsibly account for anticipated revenue in future biennia. Second, the substitute directs proceeds to the general fund while clearly stating the intent of the General Assembly that revenue be used to support gun violence prevention efforts and community safety initiatives across Virginia. This approach preserves legislative flexibility during the appropriations process while firmly establishing the policy purpose behind the revenue source. This bill does not

[01:17:17] regulate firearms. It does not restrict lawful ownership. It does not impose requirements on retailers or consumers. It simply asks manufacturers, those who make the guns, whose products carry well-documented public safety costs to contribute to prevention and intervention efforts that benefit communities statewide. Senate Bill 763 follows Virginia's long-standing use of targeted excise taxes to address public impacts, promote accountability, and

[01:17:52] support shared responsibility without raising broad-based taxes. Madam President, I renew my motion that the bill pass. The chair recognizes the senator from Rockingham. Madam President, I speak to the bill. Senator has the floor. Madam President, my ears perked up when I heard affordability. I heard it a little while ago and I pay attention when I hear that there are taxes that are not going to be passed on to consumers. You know, I don't know who people think are gonna pay these taxes but manufacturers are gonna pass the

[01:18:31] taxes along to the consumers now these are not cigarettes okay I don't know of any argument that cigarettes don't cause some health problems I oppose raising taxes on cigarettes but I hear and understand the argument that's gonna be made but what this does is it totally ignores the possibility the probability the absolute certainty that ammunition is used for perfectly legitimate purposes.

[01:19:01] I'd invite some of my colleagues from urban and suburban Virginia to come out to the country, come out and visit during hunting season. This is a hunting tax. This is a firearms tax. This is a target shooting tax.

[01:19:18] This is a tax that's going to be imposed on law-abiding gun owners across the Commonwealth of Virginia. And it's not going to make anything more affordable. I would hope that my friends would vote against this piece of legislation. The chair recognizes the senator from Portsmouth.

[01:19:38] Does the senator wish to speak? The chair recognizes the senator from King George. Thank you, Madam President.

[01:19:55] Would the senator from Norfolk yield for a question? Will the senator yield? Yes, Madam President, I'll yield. The senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. I just want to make sure that I understand this. This excise tax of 11% is in addition to the 5% or 6% sales tax.

[01:20:13] I thought somebody was firing there. Sales tax that Virginians have to already pay for firearms and ammunition. Senator from Norfolk. Madam President, that would be correct. Thank you, Madam President. Speaking to the bill. The Senator has the floor.

[01:20:30] So, Madam President, that now means we're at 16% or 17% tax on firearms and ammunition. And it's unfortunate from my perspective because we talk about disproportionate impacts on folks all the time.

[01:20:47] Well, this has a disproportionate impact and very negative effect on rural Virginia. And rural Virginians are law-abiding, hardworking, good citizens. And to impose a nearly 20% tax on a hobby that they enjoy, to me, is just unconscionable.

[01:21:10] And I really hope we won't do this. The chair recognizes the senator from Eastern Fairfax. Speaking to the bill. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Ladies and gentlemen of the Senate, first of all, I think this is a very modest proposal.

[01:21:29] My recollection is I think it generates about $60 million per year. And I just want to note for the body, the Crime Commission this year, we heard testimony from the Virginia Department of Health who told us a couple of things about firearm-related injuries. Number one, they told us that 57% of suicides in Virginia involved guns.

[01:21:49] I think there were about 1,200 suicides. And those don't end up resulting in a lot of medical expense, obviously because people are passed away. But there is long-time expense to society when people kill themselves in terms of lost the proactivity, the pain and suffering causes of family, etc.

[01:22:07] The other presentation we heard talked about firearm-related hospitalizations, both intentional and unintentional. There's a lot of unintentional firearm-related injuries that occur, and according to the Virginia Department of Health, between 2020 and 2024, firearm injury hospitalizations in Virginia cost $737 million.

[01:22:28] The Virginians also spent 34,214 days in the hospital from firearm-related injuries between 2020 and 2024. I suspect although a good chunk of that was probably paid for by Medicaid and so our taxpayers end up paying for all these injuries that are caused as some folks on to my left here like to say by these objects not by the people that are using them and I would submit that taxpayers are paying a lot of money for injuries that are caused by these products and I think this a small measure to help taxpayers cover the expense that are caused by the dangers and risks

[01:23:06] that are posed by firearms, not just for their intentional use, but also for their unintentional use. And I have the presentation, the data here, if anyone wants to talk about how often that happens. But Madam President, I think this is a modest measure and I think we should support it. The chair recognizes the Senator from Roanoke. Madam President, speak briefly to the bill.

[01:23:25] Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. So I don't think it's great when we try to say what the other side says. I did not hear anyone on our side say that, that what we just heard from the majority leader. I would also point out that what you often hear our folks on our side say is that the folks that misuse the firearms, it's those, that's what we need to deal with. That's why you see calls on our side so frequently to increase the penalties for anyone that misuses it. But to the crux of this bill, earlier this session we had an opportunity to fully eliminate the grocery tax. There's a painting behind me

[01:24:03] of a fellow that ran as a Democratic nominee for governor in the late 70s on that very platform. Thankfully we were able to get rid of the state portion during the Youngkin administration and I wish we would have gotten rid of the full portion this year. It doesn't look like that's gonna be the pleasure of the majority though. There's gonna be other legislation that's gonna increase the cost of the sales tax which will increase the cost of any prepared food all over the Commonwealth. And now this, I understand that it's not seen this way in every district, but there's a whole lot of districts where most of the meat in the freezer comes from

[01:24:40] hunting. And the food on the table most nights comes from hunting. And that's not just a one or two thing. This is common throughout large portions of this Commonwealth. And this is a direct tax on those working families. And I don't think this is right, Madam President. The chair recognizes the Senator from Stafford.

[01:25:00] Thank you, Madam President. I'm speaking to the bill. Senator has the floor. I'm looking at just hearing the amount of, that's not modest, as my colleague from King George spoke about, that's really quite significant for those who are engaging something that's quite common in this commonwealth, which is hobbies that someone like my own father did.

[01:25:22] He was an avid hunter and fisherman, and often things I had to listen to growing up was whether do you know what you're eating? Does it have feathers, fins, or fur? And it was usually something of all the above. But, you know, something also I would say is that when we're looking at tackling gun violence, my own father was the victim of a violent crime. He was a victim of, he was shot in a crime of passion by a 357 magum and it pierced his shoulder instead of his head and left him a quadriplegic for the last 20 years of his life he would never ever want any of

[01:26:00] his other hunters ever to be responsible for the the the impact of what happened in that sense that's offensive to anybody in my family or anyone else that's ever had to incur something like that this is incredibly an inappropriate and I think there's a different way that we can have this kind of conversation so they're not going up those who are seeking just to enjoy their thank you madam senator from Norfolk thank you madam president speaking to the bill senator has the floor thank you madam president gun violence is one of

[01:26:37] the highest causes of death in the Commonwealth it puts stress on our families it puts stress on our communities it puts stress in our hospitals with the number of gun violence victims that come through our hospitals every day just because someone survives an episode of being shot does not mean that they don't have lifelong repercussions in their health and mental health as they go on through their lives. I have children, Madam President, who come to my office and they tell me that they're afraid to sleep at night because they don't know if bullets are going to penetrate through their homes and if they're going to live through the night. And children

[01:27:15] should not have, little children, any children should not have to grow up with a fear that they can't even go to sleep in their own beds because they are afraid of what might happen. It is high time for manufacturers of firearms and ammunition to pay their fair share for the product that they for the cause and the harm that the product they produce does to our community. I am a registered gun owner. I've gone through all the classes. I understand this tax. It is at the manufacturer level. It is not at the point of sale. And with that, Madam President, I renew my motion that the

[01:27:55] bill pass. Madam President. Senator from King George. If no one else wishes to speak, I apologize. And I have great respect for the Senator from Norfolk, and I understand that situation, but I would respectfully submit to this body that this doesn't do anything to address that.

[01:28:16] What this does is it unfairly and punitively, I might add, impacts those people who want to participate in lawful hunting. And it was interesting to me because I assume people know as much about hunting as I do, but I was just speaking to some others.

[01:28:36] You know, I was duck hunting last weekend with a couple friends of mine, and they just bought a box of shotgun shells, and they weren't off-the-chart shotgun shells. Those shells cost $7 apiece, $7 apiece to duck hunt.

[01:28:54] A round to deer hunt now is about the same thing. And so when I stand here and say this is a significant tax, I'm not exaggerating. this is a significant tax it is hard enough for people to be able country people rural people who just want to go out and hunt and as the senator from roanoke said a lot of them this is the only meat they have is deer meat that they can hunt it's hard enough for them to buy the shotgun shells now or whatever it is that they use it's difficult to to find a decent shotgun for less than a

[01:29:31] thousand dollars and now you're going to add another 200 to the cost of that that is significant for the folks that i represent in virginia it may not be significant for people elsewhere in northern virginia or hampton roads but it is really impactful and i will tell you that there will be people who cannot afford to buy it and afford to be able to deer hunt if this is enacted the question is shall senate bill 763 pass all in favor of the motion will record their votes

[01:30:09] aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll as 21 those 19 eyes 21 nose 19 Senate Bill 763 passes.

[01:30:29] President. The Chair recognizes the Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I believe the Senate Finance Committee staff is all set to have a hearing.

[01:30:45] So I would ask that we take a 30-minute, or I'd move that we take a 30-minute recess so that the Senate Finance Committee can take a moment to meet, consider a bill, and then we can get on with our work for the remainder of the day. Madam President. Senator from Hanover.

[01:31:01] Would the Senator yield for a question? Will the Senator yield? Senator from Hanover. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I know that we're going to do the finance meeting on the floor here, and there might not have been a lot of additional notice to the public, so anybody that's watching the live stream, the purpose of this meeting is to take up the redistricting, I would refer to it as gerrymandering, of the congressional districts across Virginia, is that correct?

[01:31:35] from Eastern Fairfax. Keep trying to move me Madam President, Madam President I believe the purpose is to take up the caboose bill and there's a lot of different things in the caboose bill and one of the things that's in the caboose bill are new congressional maps and I believe the other chamber is doing the same thing today and of course their bill will be over here probably sometime next week at which point I know we'll have a committee hearing on that as well but That's part of what's in, Congressional maps are part of what's in the bill.

[01:32:13] Madam President. Senator from Hanover. Senator, yield for additional question. Will the Senator yield? Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I'd ask the Senator,

is there any ability for the public to be able to express their views on these maps that will be in the caboose bill coming up on the floor momentarily?

[01:32:36] Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Madam President, I would tell the senator that they have the ability to make phone calls, they have the ability to write, send emails, they have the ability to petition their government as they normally do, and I'm sure we'll have a hearing next week where if they choose, they can speak.

[01:32:56] I know the senator made the same point a couple weeks ago on a bill that was coming through, and we had a public hearing, and nobody showed up. So we did. I'm sure many of us received emails. That seems to be the preferred way for people to communicate today, and they can still do that. Senator from Hanover. Thank you, Madam President. One final question. Will the senator yield? I yield. Madam President, I'd ask the senator, are these maps that we're voting on, are they uploaded into the system? Can the public view them? Because I have not been provided a copy of the bill. Are they available for the public now?

[01:33:32] Senator from Eastern Fairfax.

[01:33:52] Madam President, I'd say to the senator, first of all, I believe the maps are in the caboose, and I believe they're online. I thought I saw them there this morning, and I thought there was links where you were able to link and look at them online, I think.

[01:34:09] I'll go double-check that right now. I think it was House Bill 29. I saw it, if I'm not mistaken. But I will double-check and look at it. during our break, if you want.

[01:34:30] Yeah, they're up there online. I just pulled up House Bill 29, and it says you can view the proposed maps here, view the data table here, download the shapefile block equivalency files here. It's on under HB 29. - Madam President, Senator yield for-- - Senator from Hanover.

[01:34:48] - Madam President, I know the gentleman, the Senator and I, at one point did serve in the House, but it's been a couple decades for me. Are they on the Senate bill? - Sorry, Madam President, I yield-- - Senator from Eastern Fairfax. - I yield. Thank you, Senator.

[01:35:03] And I believe they might not be in the Senate bill. Maybe they're only in the House bill. Thank you, Senator. Okay. Without objection, the Senate will be in recess.

[01:35:15] Senate Finance Committee will come to order.

[01:40:13] Madam Clerk, would you please call the roll? Senator Rouse. Senator Pillian. Senator Boisco. Senator McPike. Senator Survelle. Senator Favola. Senator Reeves.

[01:40:28] Here. Senator Stewart. Here. Senator Obenshain. Senator McDougall. Senator Eben. here senator marsden senator locke senator deeds senator lucas here you have a quorum madam chair thank you madam clerk okay we know the reason why we're here is to deal with uh senate bill 29 uh senator deeds i'm going to ask that you adopt the amendment i'm sorry i need april 1st senator can i first hear from april madam chair i just wanted to quickly describe what's going to be in front

[01:41:08] of you. These are amendments to Senate Bill 29 as introduced. You should have a packet on your desk, but I'm going to quickly summarize those for you. These are changes to the introduced bill as the previous governor introduced. There's an amendment package of nine amendments, the first of which adjusts the front page for the resources that are incorporated here. The next amendment, 77-1-S, delays

some reporting for a deadline for election audits from for six months the second amendment our third amendment 125 number 1s and 461 1s and 469 2s have

[01:41:47] to do with the employee bonuses for state employees and teachers instead of a 2% bonus it is a $1,500 per employee bonus there's some additional language there that allows some flexibility for both k-12 and higher ed in case they cannot do the bonus before the end of the fiscal year that money will be carried over there's some again flexibility language I do just want to mention even though there's not amendment because we don't have exact numbers of the state supported local employees it actually stays as a two percent bonus the other two bonuses for teachers and state employees have been

[01:42:22] converted to the $1,500 amount to provide more funding to lower income employees versus the higher income employees. Amendment 416, sorry that was a part of the bonus. Amendment C34 number 1S removes some language relating to the disposition or potential relocation of DMV headquarters. That can be a biannual budget decision that allows you for some additional time. Amendment 4-5.104 number 1S restores language in 4.504 related to the funding of abortion

[01:42:58] services. So that's unstriking language that the Governor Youngkin struck. The next amendment, Amendment 4-14 No. 1S, includes a revised primary and filing schedule for the November 3rd, 2026 general election, schedules the 2026 primary election for August 4th, 2026, and modifies Virginia's 11 congressional districts. Amendment No. 4-14 No. 2S includes language to conform state tax provisions to H.R. 1 and sets a fixed conformity date of December 31st 2025. There's a table that does some further instructions for you there. The 10 amendments

[01:43:35] reflect revenue increases totaling almost 201 million from tax conformity, which is reduced by the spending adjustments of 4 million, which is converting that proposed 2% bonus to the 1500 bonus for teachers and state employees. No other spending or savings proposals from the introduced bill have been changed or eliminated. Madam Chair, that completes my summary. The amendments are attached and another table summarizing those actions in this packet for you thank you april i'm sorry to have been in such a big hurry here madam chairman there's a motion and a second that

[01:44:10] i'm chairman can we ask some questions over may i finish ma'am chairman could we ask some questions yes madam chairman april on the bonuses switching from two percent to fifteen hundred dollars is there a is that net even on the amount of dollars going to employees or is it reduction or increase so madam chair senator mcdougall from a cost total cost perspective it's 4 million more but it actually um you're giving 11 more under k-12 and you're saving seven for state employees

[01:44:46] and that's just based on the average salary but what i would say is a two percent bonus for a lower paid employee would be less than the fifteen hundred dollars and so the thought was to convert it to that a dollar amount whereas higher employees would get a larger bonus than that fifteen hundred dollar amount. Madam Chairman Senator McDougall just so the amount of dollars spent for all the bonuses so the amount going to employees is it more than in the introduced bill or less? Madam Chair Senator McDougall it's four million more between the two

[01:45:22] actions. Thank you, Madam Chair. Further questions of staff? Senator Deeds, Senator Deeds moves to adopt the subject. Senator DeLock seconds that we adopt the amendment. All in favor, please, this is gonna be a voice vote, all say aye. Nose have the same right. We will record your nose.

[01:45:54] Senator Deeds, can you make a motion? There's a motion in a second that Senate Bill 29 be reported as amended madam chair senate senate open chain um madam chair i guess question we're going through this so fast um the amendments that we adopted were not just the um changes in terms of the financial changes to the introduced budget but they also include

[01:46:29] if i'm correct the the um redistricting um amendments that new maps is that right that is correct april could you please respond madam chair center obenshain yes if you look at that summary on the page two of that summary in the very front amendment 4-14 number 1s includes that um the congressional districts are the redistricting okay um senator obenshain madam Chairman Chair, if I can speak to the Caboose Bill in its current form before we vote, I'd

[01:47:06] be grateful. You know, I last night did see the maps for the first time, I can't say that they were totally surprising in light of the talk, the chatter that has been emanating around the General Assembly for the past week or so but looking at the maps just on paper I couldn't tell exactly where the district lines were going I have in the

[01:47:45] five minutes since we were handed this I did was able to take a look at the 7th congressional district. I was able to look at my county and just using that as those as an example, I find it rather stunning to see Rockingham County divided up into three different congressional districts. I wonder about the community of interest and the compactness.

[01:48:24] My part of Rockingham County, very rural northern Rockingham County, agricultural, is in the seventh district along with Culpeper, Goochland, Green, Louisa, Madison, Orange, Powhatan, arguably all of those share some community of interest with northern Rockingham, but it also includes Falls Church and Arlington and I scratch my head and am perplexed at the any

[01:49:01] possible community of interest between those areas and the rural areas I just listed, I looked at, you know, the geographic continuity and it is, as I guess you can see, it's a pretty complicated, convoluted map and it's reminiscent of some of the districts

[01:49:39] that, you know, are used as examples in textbooks and probably on Wikipedia under gerrymandering. It is, I can see a couple of animal shapes in there and other shapes in there.

[01:49:57] I also wonder whether this is, and I don't wonder, I strongly believe that this map causes federal constitutional problems in terms of the highly non-compact districts, the political subdivision fragmentation, which I just described in at least even in my home jurisdiction, I submit that that's far beyond what's necessary. It has been discussed as generating a projected

[01:50:35] 10 to 1 partisan outcome in a state that's nowhere near a 90 to 10% political division. I would respectfully submit that it creates equal protection violations, that it is going to raise First Amendment retaliation claims, and as we've been talking about for the past week or two, that these are maps that are enacted without lawful state authority and

[01:51:12] in contravention of the constitutional amendment that we adopted several years ago. The map in terms of equal protection and vote dilution overconcentrates Republican voters in a small number of districts.

[01:51:30] I saw some analysis late last night that indicated that the current 9th district, and I don't know what it's labeled now, but Southwest Virginia is a R plus 45.

[01:51:47] I'd love to have an R plus 45 district, but I guess that, as the former Senate Majority leader, the former senior senator from Fairfax, once told me when looking at my district going through the first redistricting in 2010, he said, Obenshain, we tried, but we couldn't cram another Republican voter into your district. I'm impressed at the ability to cram more Republican voters into the 9th district, but I respectfully submit that that creates significant equal

[01:52:25] protection violations which are going to be the subject of, I hope will be the subject of litigation. It also raises the serious issue of whether political affiliation is being punished or disfavored. And those claims are viable under the 14th Amendment, particularly when paired with statements of intent that have been made during the course of this General Assembly

[01:52:57] session. So, you know, I'm dismayed. I have no illusions as to the outcome of this committee vote, but these are just observations that in the few minutes that I've had to reflect upon and look at this map, I feel compelled to share with the body, especially in light of the fact that there is no public participation in this.

[01:53:24] I don't know that there was any public notice of this meeting or an opportunity for any member of the public to weigh in before we embark upon consideration and vote on this this map so madam chair I thank you for your indulgence I thank you for listening to me I will vote no and I certainly hope that a few of my colleagues will do so as well Senator Stewart thank you madam chair I had a question for someone I listened to April in response to

[01:54:01] Senator McDougall's questions, and I think I understand it, but at the end of the day, the state employees are going to get less. Is that correct? Madam Chair, Senator Stewart, because of the state salaries being slightly higher than that of the teachers, yes, it would be slightly less as far as the total amount. So Madam Chair, so there's a cost savings there but had had we already told them they were going to get a two percent bonus madam chair

[01:54:36] senator stewart it was in the introduced budget as a two percent what i would argue is nothing's ever final until it's passed but you know whether individuals understand that or not it remains to be seen is it fair to say april that there may have been an expectation out there by state employees that they were going to get a two percent bonus which they're now not going to get i'm not trying to be argumentative i just i'm sensitive to this madam chair center stewart i would say my guess would be you have a spectrum of thoughts and feelings across that with um lower

[01:55:11] paid employees being would be happier with this the higher paid employees might be aggravated and many probably having no idea about the action as well madam chair april would make a very good politician thank thank you madam chair questions from any other member of the committee madam chairman senator mcdougall thank you madam chairman and madam chairman I just want to say I appreciate the courtesies that we're able to speak with each other on individually but madam chairman this is

[01:55:46] a big deal this is redistricting the congressional districts for every Virginian so Virginians that thought that they were gonna be able to vote with their friends and neighbors in certain areas are now going to learn today because it wasn't available to them to learn yesterday and the members of this body just received it moments ago that they're no longer going to be able to vote with their friends and neighbors I know that in my area multiple counties James City County is now divided Hanover County is now

[01:56:22] divided. And, Madam President, as we're going through and having disagreements, certainly legitimate to have that. This is partisan political gerrymandering. The only purpose is to create a partisan political advantage. There's no other goal. There's no other objective. And, Madam President, we are also putting it into a budget bill. This is traditionally one of the budget bills that we come

[01:56:55] together and have agreements on things that need to be addressed quickly. So as this is moving forward, it's clear where the votes will be today, but Virginians should be upset. Virginians should be upset that we are not focusing on things that they care about, that this is one of the biggest policy decisions moving out of this chamber, and it spends five million of their dollars

[01:57:25] to create a political gerrymander and we're doing it now. I, Madam President, I hope that some of my colleagues will really think about this and think about what message Virginians are receiving. The message that we care, some people care more about political games than they do about how they make it through everyday life. So, Madam President, I would hope that we would not move this forward

[01:58:01] and that we would come back and find a way to work together on things that are important for Virginians and not just political advantage for one party. Questions or statements by other members of the committee? I can't resist this opportunity to say for the almost 30 years that I've served in the Senate of Virginia, it's only been the last two years that I've served the district that only had two localities in it. Prior to that, it had 12 localities.

[01:58:40] Portsmouth, Chesapeake, Suffolk, Franklin, Southampton County, Holloway County, Brunswick County, South Boston, Surrey, and of course there are a few others. Because as the redistricting happened, it changed. Those people started to love me, so I think these people will eventually like their districts. Um, Senator Deeds, there's a motion by Senator Deeds and a second by Senator Locke that the bill be reported. This is gonna be an electronic vote.

[01:59:06] She's got a roll call. You're gonna call the roll? Oh, thank you. Senator Rouse, Senator Pillian, Senator Boisco, Senator McPike, Senator Suravelle, Senator Favola, Senator Reeves, Senator Stewart, Senator Obenshain, Senator McDougall, Senator Eben.

[01:59:33] Yes. Senator Marsden, Senator Locke, Senator Deeds, Senator Lucas. Aye. Ayes 10, noes 5. Ayes 10, noes 5. The bill is reported. There being no further business to come before the Senate Finance Committee.

[01:59:53] Committee to arise uncontested calendar Senate bills on second reading the chair recognizes the senator from Eastern Fairfax

[02:12:44] Madam president. I moved all the Senate bills on second reading on the uncontested calendars on pages 17 through 21 Senate bill 144 through 784 be advanced engrossment third reading in the block at the adoption of amendments there to any senators are removed bill from the block She'll do so after the clerk has read the number of the bill

[02:12:59] The question is, shall all the Senate bills on second reading on the uncontested calendar on pages 17 through 21 Senate Bill 144 through Senate Bill 784 be engrossed and advanced to their third reading in the block after the adoption of the amendments thereto that any senator desiring to remove a bill from the block will do so after the clerk has read the number of the bill.

[02:13:24] All in favor of the motion will say aye. Any opposed no. The ayes have it. The motion is agreed to. The clerk will read the number of the bills. Senate Bill 144, reported from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations. Senate Bill 167, reported from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations.

[02:13:46] Senate Bill 182, reported from the Committee on General Laws and Technology with a substitute, and from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations. The chair recognizes the senator from Norfolk. Madam President, I move the committee substitute be agreed to. The question is, shall the substitute from the committee on general laws and technology be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to.

[02:14:14] Senate Bill 196, reported from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations. Senate Bill 383, reported from the Committee on Agriculture, Conservation, and Natural Resources, with a substitute. The chair recognizes the senator from Shenandoah.

[02:14:32] Madam President, I move the subcommittee substitute. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee on Agriculture, Conservation, and Natural Resources be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye.

[02:14:47] Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. Senate Bill 390, reported from the Committee on Agriculture, Conservation and Natural Resources. Senate Bill 484, reported from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations with a substitute.

[02:15:04] The chair recognizes the senator from Charlottesville. Madam President, I move to adoption of the committee's substitute. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye.

[02:15:21] Aye. no the ayes have it the substitute is agreed to Senate bill 486 reported from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations with the substitute the chair recognizes the senator from King George thank you madam president I've moved the substitute be agreed to the question is shall the substitute from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations be agreed to all in favor of that motion will say aye any opposed no the ayes have it the substitute is

[02:15:47] agreed to. Senate Bill 606. The chair recognizes a Senator from Portsmouth. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move the committee substitute from Senate Finance Appropriations be agreed to. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations be agreed to? All in favor of that motion, we'll say aye.

[02:16:12] Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. Senate Bill 720, reported from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations with the substitute. the chair recognizes senator from arlington thank you madam president madam president i move that the substitute be agreed to shall the question is shall the substitute from the committee on finance and appropriations be agreed to all in favor of that motion we'll say aye any opposed no the ayes have it the substitute is agreed to senate bill 784 reported from the committee on agriculture

[02:16:47] conservation and natural resources with a substitute the chair recognizes the senator from King George. President, I move the substitute be agreed to. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee on Agriculture, Conservation, and Natural Resources be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to.

[02:17:09] The question is, shall the Senate bills be engrossed and advanced to their third reading? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The bills are now engrossed and advanced to their third reading. Regular calendar Senate bills on second reading.

[02:17:29] Senate Bill 388, a bill relating to affordable housing, religious organizations, and other non-profit tax-exempt properties reported from the Committee on Local Government with a substitute. The chair recognizes the senior senator from Prince William. Thank you, Madam President. Move that bill go by for the day. Without objection, Senate Bill 388 goes by for the day. Senate Bill 94, A bill relating to siting of data centers, property, and zone for industrial use.

[02:18:02] Reported from the Committee on Local Government with amendments and from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations with a substitute. The Chair recognizes the Senator from Western Prince William. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, may this bill please go by for the day. Without objection, Senate Bill 94 goes by for the day.

[02:18:19] Senate Bill 314, a bill relating to Tourism Improvement District's Transient Occupancy Tax, Arlington County, reported from the Committee on Local Government with a floor substitute.

[02:18:35] The chair recognizes the senator from Alexandria. Yes, could that bill go by for the day before consideration of any substitute? Without objection, Senate Bill 314 goes by for the day. Senate Bill 15, relating to driver improvement clinics, motorcycle driver improvement clinics, motorcycle driver improvement clinic fund created, reported from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations with a substitute.

[02:19:04] The chair recognizes the senator from Roanoke. Madam President, maybe we should have put them all on a block. I ask that this also go by for the day. Without objection, Senate Bill 15 goes by for the day. Senate bill 27 a bill relating to firearm industry members standards of responsible conduct civil liability reported from the committee for courts of justice with a substitute and from the committee on finance and appropriations the chair recognizes the senator from Eastern Prince William thank

[02:19:41] you madam president I do not want my bill to go by for the day and I move that the substitute from courts of justice committee be agreed to the The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee for Courts of Justice be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed?

[02:19:56] No. The substitute is agreed to. Senator from Prince William. Thank you, Madam President. I move that the bill be engrossed and advanced to its third reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 27 now be engrossed and advanced to its third reading? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed?

[02:20:12] No. The bill is engrossed and advanced. bill 38 a bill relating to firearm transfers to another person from a prohibited person reported from the committee for courts of justice with amendments and from the committee on finance and appropriations the chair recognizes the senator from Arlington thank you madam president um madam president I move that the amendments be agreed to the question is shall the amendments from the committee for courts of justice be agreed to all in favor of that motion we'll say aye aye any opposed no the ayes have it the amendments are agreed to. Senator from Arlington. Thank you, Madam President. I

[02:20:49] move that the bill be engrossed in advance to its third reading. The question is, shall the bill be engrossed in advance to its third reading? All in favor of the motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. Senate Bill 38 is engrossed and advanced. Senate Bill 115, a bill relating to concealed handgun

permits reciprocity with other states. Reported from the Committee for Courts justice with the substitute and from the committee on finance and appropriation with amendments and there is a floor amendment the chair recognizes a senator from western fairfax

[02:21:23] madam president i move that the substitute from the committee of courts be uh what agreed to the question is shall the substitute from the committee for courts of justice be agreed to all in favor of that motion, we'll say aye. Any opposed, no. The substitute is agreed to. Senator from Western Fairfax. With the recommendation that it be rejected, I move the amendment from the Committee on Finance be agreed to. With the recommendation that the amendment from the

[02:21:59] committee... It'll make sense. No? Madam President. Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Can I say this bill go by for the day so we can talk about it before we do this without objection senate bill 115 goes by for the day senate bill 160 a bill relating to purchase possession or transportation

[02:22:29] of firearm assault or and battery of a family or household member or intimate partner penalty reported from the committee on finance and appropriations the chair recognizes the senior senator from loudon thank you madame president madame president i move this bill be engrossed in advance to its third constitutional reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 160 be engrossed in advance to its third reading? All in favor of that motion will say aye.

[02:22:57] Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The bill is engrossed and advanced. Senate Bill 173, a bill relating to weapons possession prohibited in a hospital that provides mental health services or developmental services penalty reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice with a substitute and from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations. The chair recognizes the senator from Norfolk. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move that the substitute be agreed to. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee for Courts of Justice be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The substitute is

[02:23:34] agreed to. Senator from Norfolk. Thank you, Madam President. I move that the bill be engrossed and advanced to its third constitutional reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 173 be engrossed and advanced to its third reading? All in favor of that motion, we'll say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The bill is engrossed and advanced. Senate Bill 261, a bill relating to cruelty to animals, malicious wounding of a dog or cat penalty, reported from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations. The chair recognizes

[02:24:07] a senator from Franklin County. Thank you, Madam President. I'd now move that we engrossed and advance Senate Bill 261 to its third constitutional reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 261 now be engrossed and advanced to his third reading. All in favor of that motion will say aye.

[02:24:26] Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. Senate Bill 261 is engrossed and advanced. Senate Bill 272, relating to carrying a firearm or explosive material within Capitol Square or building owned or leased by the Commonwealth, exemptions, public institutions of higher education, penalty.

[02:24:46] Reporting from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations. The chair recognizes the senator from Charlottesville. Madam President, I move that this bill be engrossed in advance to a third constitutional reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 272 now be engrossed in advance to its third reading? All in favor of the motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The bill is engrossed and advanced. Senate Bill 276, a bill relating to state correctional facilities, visitation policies, annual

reports reported from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations with substitute the chair recognizes the senator from Norfolk thank you madam

[02:25:25] president madam president I move that the committee substitute be agreed to the question is shall the substitute from the committee on finance and appropriations be agreed to all in favor of that motion will say aye any opposed no the substitute is agreed to senator from Norfolk thank you madam president madam president I move that the bill be engrossed and advanced to its third constitutional reading the question is shall Senate bill 276 now be engrossed in advance to his third reading. All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and advanced.

[02:25:58] Senate Bill 322, a bill relating to the presidential electors and the agreement among the states to elect the president by national popular vote compact, reported from the Committee on Privileges and Elections.

[02:26:13] The chair recognizes the senator from Alexandria. Thank you, Madam President. I move the bill be engrossed and advanced to its third reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 322 now be engrossed and advanced to its third reading? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no.

[02:26:29] The ayes have it. The bill is engrossed and advanced. Senate Bill 323, a bill relating to manufacture, importation, sale, transfer, or possession of plastic firearms in unfinished frames or receivers and unserialized firearms prohibited penalties reported from the Committee on Finance and Approach.

[02:26:52] appropriations. The chair recognizes the senator from Alexandria. Thank you, Madam President. I move the bill be engrossed in advance to its third constitutional reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 323 now be engrossed in advance to its third reading? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The bill is engrossed in advance. Senate Bill 340, a bill relating to small renewable energy projects, agrivoltaics definition advisory panel reported from the Committee on Agriculture, Conservation, and Natural Resources with a substitute.

[02:27:27] The chair recognizes the senior senator from Loudoun. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move the bill be engrossed in advance to its third constitutional reading. Senator, we have a substitute that we must agree to first. Madam President, I move the substitute from the Committee on Agriculture, Conservation, and Natural Resources.

[02:27:48] Thank you, Senator. The question is, shall the substitute now be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed? No. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. Senior Senator from Loudoun. Madam President, I now move that the bill be engrossed in advance to its third constitutional reading.

[02:28:08] The question is, shall Senate Bill 340 be engrossed in advance to its third reading? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed? No. The bill is engrossed in advance. Senate Bill 344, a bill relating to Department of Wildlife Resources, Premature Separation and hybridization of mammalian wildlife prohibited exceptions reported from the committee on agriculture conservation and natural resources with a substitute the chair recognizes the senator from northern Fairfax madam president I move the committee substitute be agreed to the question is shall the substitute from

[02:28:46] the committee on agriculture conservation and natural resources be agreed to all in favor of that motion we'll say aye any opposed no the ayes ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. Senator from

Northern Fairfax. Madam President, I move that the bill be engrossed in advance to its third constitutional reading. The question is, shall the bill now be engrossed in advance to its third reading? All in favor of the motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The bill is engrossed in advance.

[02:29:14] Senate Bill 348, a bill relating to storage of firearms in a residence where a minor or persons prohibited from possessing a firearm is present. Penalty reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice with amendments and from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations.

[02:29:32] The chair recognizes the senator from Northern Fairfax. Madam President, I move that the committee amendments be agreed to. The question is, shall the amendments from the Committee for Courts of Justice be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The amendments are agreed to. Senator from Northern Fairfax. Madam President, I move that the bill be engrossed and advanced to its third constitutional reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 348 now be engrossed and advanced to its third reading? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The bill is engrossed and advanced.

[02:30:08] Senate Bill 352, a bill relating to law enforcement officers' restrictions on wearing of facial coverings, exceptions, civil liability penalty, reported from the Committee of Courts of Justice with amendments, and from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations.

[02:30:32] Senator from Central Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, with the recommendation that the amendments be rejected from the Committees of Finance and Appropriation, I move that the amendments be agreed to.

[02:30:48] I believe the correct motion, Senator, is that the rejection of the amendments from the Committee for Courts of Justice. Is that the motion you wish to make? That's correct, Madam President. With the recommendation that the amendments from the Committee for Courts of Justice be rejected shall the amendments be agreed to all in favor of that motion will say aye all opposed will say no the committee amendments are rejected senator from central fairfax thank you madam president i move that the substitute from the committee of finance and appropriation be agreed

[02:31:22] to the question is shall the substitute from the committee on finance and appropriations be agreed to. All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. Senator from Central Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I move that the bill be engrossed in advance to its third reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 352 now be engrossed in advance to its third reading? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The bill is engrossed and advanced. Senate Bill 384, a bill relating to Virginia Information Technologies Agency, Artificial Intelligence,

[02:32:01] Independent Verification Organizations, reported from the Committee on General Laws and Technology with a substitute, and from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations with a substitute. - The Chair recognizes the Senator from Norfolk. - Thank you, Madam President.

[02:32:17] Madam President, with the recommendation that the substitute be rejected, I move that the substitute be agreed to. The question is, with the recommendation that the substitute from the Committee on General Laws and Technology be rejected, the question is, shall the substitute be agreed to?

[02:32:38] All in favor of the motion will say aye. All opposed will say no. No. The substitute from General Laws and Technology is rejected. Senator from Norfolk. Thank you, Madam President. I move that the

substitute from Finance and Appropriations be agreed to.

[02:32:57] The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Aye. Any opposed? No. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. Senator from Norfolk. Thank you. And finally, Madam President, I move that the bill be engrossed and advanced to its third reading.

[02:33:15] The question is, shall Senate Bill 384 now be engrossed and advanced to its third reading? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed? No. The bill is engrossed and advanced. Senate Bill 461, a bill relating to Marine Resources Commission commercial electro-fishing licenses reported from the Committee on Agriculture, Conservation, and Natural Resources with a substitute.

[02:33:41] Senator from King George. Thank you, Madam President. I move the substitute be agreed to. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee on Agriculture, Conservation, and Natural Resources be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed? No. The substitute is agreed to. Senator from King George.

[02:33:59] Thank you, Madam President. I move we engross and advance the bill to its third reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 461 now be engrossed and advanced to its third reading? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed? No. The ayes have it. The bill is engrossed and advanced.

[02:34:14] Senate Bill 489, a bill relating to financial institutions and services, virtual currency kiosk operators, license required penalty, reported from the Committee on Commerce and Labor with a substitute and from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations.

[02:34:33] Senator from Central Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I move that the Committee's substitute be agreed to. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee on Commerce and Labor be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Aye. Aye.

[02:34:49] Any opposed? No. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. Senator from Central Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I move that the bill be engrossed and advanced to its third reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 489 now be engrossed and advanced to its third reading?

[02:35:05] All in favor of that motion will say aye. Aye. Any opposed? No. The ayes have it. The bill is engrossed and advanced. bill 553 a bill relating to certain data for water users water use consumption of data centers reported for the committee on agriculture conservation and natural resources with the substitute the junior senator from loudon thank you madam president i move the committee substitute be agreed to the question is shall the substitute from the committee on agriculture conservation and natural resources be agreed to all in favor of that motion will say aye any opposed no the ayes

[02:35:43] Have it the substitute is agreed to senator junior senator from loudon. Madam president. I know move the bill be engrossed and advanced to its third Constitutional reading the question is shall Senate bill 553 now be engrossed and advanced to his third reading all in favor of that motion will say aye Any opposed no the bill is engrossed and advanced Senate bill 632 a bill relating to Elections candidates and elected officials address Reported from the committee on privileges and elections with the substitute the chair recognizes the senator from Eastern Henrico

[02:36:21] Thank you so much madam president. I move the committee steps to be agreed to the question is shall the substitute from the committee on Privileges and elections be agreed to all in favor of that

motion. We'll say aye Any opposed no the eyes have it the substitute is agreed to senator from Eastern Henrico Thank you so much madam president. I move the will be engrossed and passed on to its third reading The question is, shall Senate Bill 632 be engrossed and advanced to its third reading?

[02:36:52] All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The bill is engrossed and advanced. Senate Bill 636, a bill to direct the Department of General Services to approve all Confederate monuments, to remove all Confederate monuments and memorials from Capitol Square.

[02:37:14] Reported from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations with a substitute. Senator from Alexandria. Thank you, Madam President. First, I move that we adopt the committee substitute. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. Senator from Alexandria.

[02:37:39] Thank you, Madam President. Now I move the bill be engrossed and advanced to its third reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 636 now be engrossed and advanced to its third greeting. All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and advanced. Senate Bill 670, a bill relating to automated driving systems reported from the Committee on Transportation with amendments and from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations with a substitute. Senator from Central Fairfax. Madam President, could that bill go by for the day?

[02:38:12] Without objection, Senate Bill 670 goes by for the day. Senate Bill 727, a bill relating to carrying loaded firearms in public areas prohibited in the Commonwealth. Penalty reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice with a substitute and from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations with a substitute.

[02:38:35] Senator from Richmond City. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, with the recommendation that the substitute be rejected, I move that the substitute from the Committee for Courts of Justice be agreed to. With the recommendation that the substitute from the Committee for Courts of Justice be rejected, the question is, shall the substitute be agreed to?

[02:38:58] All in favor of that motion will say aye. All opposed will say no. The substitute from the Committee for Courts of Justice is rejected. Senator from Richmond City. Madam President, I move the committee substitute be agreed to. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations be agreed to?

[02:39:17] All in favor of that motion will say aye. Aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The substitute from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations is agreed to. Senator from Richmond City. Yes, Madam President, I move the bill be engrossed in advance to its third reading.

[02:39:32] The question is, shall Senate Bill 727 now be engrossed in advance to its third reading? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed? No. The ayes have it. Senate Bill 727 is engrossed and advanced. Senate Bill 749, a bill relating to purchase, possession, sale, transfer, etc. of assault, firearms, and certain ammunition feeding devices prohibited penalty reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice with a substitute and from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations with a substitute.

[02:40:08] Senator from Central Fairfax. Thank you Madam President. With the recommendation that the substitute from the courts of justice committee be rejected, I move that the substitute be agreed to. With

the recommendation that the substitute from the committee for courts of justice be rejected, the question is, shall the substitute be agreed to?

[02:40:30] All in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. No. the substitute from Committee for Courts of Justice the substitute the substitute from the Committee for Courts of Justice is rejected Senate Senator from Central Fairfax thank you madam president madam president I move that the substitute from the Committee of Finance and Appropriation be agreed to the question is shall the substitute from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations be agreed to all in favor of that motion we'll say aye aye any opposed no the substitute is agreed to senator from central fairfax thank you madam president

[02:41:09] i move that the bill be engrossed and advanced to its third reading the question is shall senate bill 749 now be engrossed and advanced to his third reading all in favor of that motion we'll say aye thank you any opposed no the eyes have it senate bill 749 is engrossed and advanced Senate Bill 802, a bill relating to clean energy and community flood preparedness market-based trading program reported from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations.

[02:41:43] The chair recognizes the senator from Hampton. Thank you, Madam President. I move the Senate Bill 802 be engrossed in advance to its third reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 802 now be engrossed in advance to its third reading? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed? No. The bill is engrossed in advance.

[02:42:03] Senate Bill 831, a bill relating to elections, challenges of qualified voters, duty of local electoral board to certify civil penalty, reported from the Committee on Privileges and Elections with the substitute.

[02:42:19] The junior senator from Loudoun. Madam President. The senior senator from Prince William. Thank you, Madam President. I move that this bill be committed to the Committee on Senate Finance and Appropriations. With the recommendation that the bill be re-referred to the Senate Committee on Finance and Appropriations, all in favor of that motion will say aye.

[02:42:51] Any opposed? No. The ayes have it. The bill is re-referred to the Committee on Finance and Appropriations. Senate Bill 832, a bill relating to vulnerable road user safety zones, vulnerable road user safety improvement fund civil penalties reports reported from the committee on finance and appropriations with the substitute junior senator from loudon thank you madam president i move the committee substitute be agreed to the question is shall the substitute from the committee on finance and appropriations be agreed to all in favor of that motion will say aye any opposed no the ayes

[02:43:28] have it the substitute is agreed to junior senator from loudon thank you madam president i now move the bill be engrossed and advanced to its third constitutional reading the question is shall senate bill 832 now be engrossed and advanced to his third reading all in favor of that motion will say aye any opposed no the eyes have it the bill is engrossed and advanced uncontested calendar senate bills on first reading the chair recognizes the senator from eastern fairfax madam president move on the senate bills on first reading on the uncontested and regular calendars pages 38 through 46, Senate Bills 85 through 803, that the rules be suspended in the first constitutional

[02:44:08] reading of the titles be dispensed with. The question is, shall the rules be suspended in the first constitutional reading of the titles of the Senate bills on the uncontested and regular calendars, pages 38 through 46, Senate Bill 85 through Senate Bill 803, be dispensed with?

[02:44:26] All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye, those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll.

[02:44:44] Ayes 39, noes 0. Ayes 39, noes 0. The reading of the titles is dispensed with. Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Senator President, I move that all those bills be passed by for the day. The question is, shall the Senate bills on the uncontested and regular calendars, now on their second reading, be passed by for the day?

[02:45:05] All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The bills will go by for the day. Madam President. Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Madam President, I'd ask that all the remaining resolutions on the calendar, both the uncontested calendar and the regular calendar, be passed by for the day.

[02:45:22] And blocked. Without objection, the resolutions will go by for the day. Madam President.

[02:45:40] Senator from Central Fairfax. Madam President, having voted on the prevailing side, i move to reconsider the vote by which senate bill 586 on page 15 uh passed so that a member

[02:45:57] could vote senator which bill was that 586 senate bill 586 on page 15. thank you senator the question is shall the vote by which the senate bill 586 passed be reconsidered all in

[02:46:36] favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll ayes 39 no zero ayes 39 no zero the motion is agreed to senator from central fairfax thank you madam president having previously explained the bill i move that we pass the question is shall senate bill 586 pass all in favor of the motion will record their votes aye those opposed

[02:47:12] no. Are the Senators ready to vote? Have all the Senators voted? Do any Senators desire to change their vote? The Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 23, noes 16. Ayes 23,

[02:47:31] noes 16. Senate Bill 586 passes. Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Madam President, I'll sit down. Thank you Senator. Supplemental calendar number one for Friday, February 6, 2026. Regular calendar Senate bill on first reading. Senate bill 29. Budget bill

[02:48:09] amendments, amends and reenacts chapter 725 of the Acts of Assembly of 2025, which appropriates the public revenues for two years ending respectively on June 30, 2025 and June 30, 2026. Reported from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations with amendments.

[02:48:32] Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Inquiry to the clerk. Yes, sir. Does that complete today's calendar before this weekend? Yes, sir. Is there any other business to come before the Senate?

[02:48:50] Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Senator, President, rise for an announcement. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Ladies and gentlemen, the Senate, we wanted to make sure everybody was aware of how we're going to run the calendar next week. normally as we approach crossover we start accelerating bills that are on second read uncontested all the way through to final passage on on the same day and so we're going to start doing that starting on tuesday so please be aware that if you see a bill on first read uncontested it's likely to pass the next day it's uncontested so just be aware we do that every

[02:49:29] year speeds things up and that's the plan for next week the clerk will report any announcements on the desk. Monday, February 9th, 2026, the Committee for Courts of Justice will meet at

8 a.m. Senate Room A, GAB. The Committee on Local Government will meet at 8.30 a.m. in Senate Room B, GAB. The Education and Health Subcommittee on Higher Education will meet at 8.30 a.m.

[02:50:01] in Senate Room C, GAB. The Democratic Caucus will meet at 11.15 a.m. in Senate Room 1 of the capitol the republican caucus will meet at 11 30 a.m in senate room 2 of the capitol reminder that tonight is the opening ceremony for the olympics the super bowl is this weekend and the puppy bowl is this weekend weekend weather report highs in the low 40s today partly cloudy skies will become overcast in the afternoon snow showers or a mix of rain and snow are possible by the afternoon and

[02:50:41] early evening. Very little or no accumulation is expected. Tonight, partly cloudy and turning bitter cold with possible flurries. Lows near 21. Saturday, mostly sunny skies, bitterly cold and windy. Wind gusts are expected to reach 35 to 50 miles per hour. Highs in the 20s. Sunday, moderate to cold weather for the day. Partly sunny skies. Highs in the 30s and lows expected to drop under 20 degrees. Happy weekend. The chair recognizes the senator

[02:51:21] from Portsmouth. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move that the Senate do now adjourn until 12 noon on Monday. The question is, shall the Senate now adjourn until 12 noon Monday? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed? No. The ayes have it. The motion is agreed to the Senate stands adjourned until 12 noon Monday past meetings and explore our full

[02:51:47] archives anytime on the Senate of Virginia's YouTube channel is the Senate of Virginia

[02:52:54] Richmond Virginia Senate chamber this is the Senate of Virginia Richmond Virginia

